

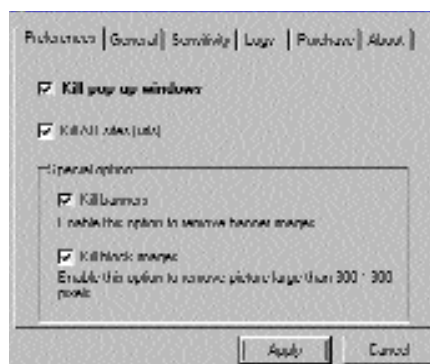
30 Minutes Expert

Bust those ads

You are coasting along the cyber-bahn and suddenly get hit by a speed breaker in the shape of a popup advertisement. A picturesque image of Bali invites you for that dream vacation or a lissome beauty draped over a couch offers you information on a wireless camera. These popups are irritating to say the least while you are surfing around casually and especially so if you are working online. The solution? Install an ad buster and escape those nagging popups. AD Killer from www.softcows.com is one of the simplest and best ad busters. Installing and configuring the software is child's play.

Preparing the 'hit' list

After you've installed AD Killer, launch the application from the **Start > Programs** menu. The software opens up in a small window. Here you can select the types of ads that you want to block. For instance, you

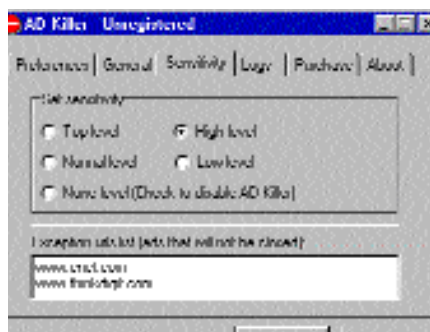


Select the kind of ads you want to block

can kill banners and block images that are larger than 300x300 pixels. Select the options as per your requirements and click on the 'Apply' button to close the window and activate AD Killer.

Setting the rules

If you are still unable to stop some



Select the level of sensitivity, or select 'None' to disable Ad Killer when working with download managers

ads from popping up, it could be because the sensitivity level is set to 'Low'. For instance, if you've selected a low level of sensitivity, the software will only block ads that match a few standard rules, such as images served from familiar ad servers or images that follow the standard banner ad sizes, or text that contains words such as buy or save. On the other hand, selecting 'Top level' will block all the popup windows, but this will slow down your surfing speed as AD Killer will prefetch the data, analyse it and then serve up the Web page sans all popups.

You can change the sensitivity level through the 'Sensitivity' tab in the application window. Alternatively, right-click on the AD Killer icon on the system tray to change the level of sensitivity.

You can also disable the application by choosing 'None' under the 'Sensitivity' tab. This option would be required when working with download managers, which have popup windows for individual software downloads. To prevent these windows from being closed accidentally, you can temporarily disable AD Killer.

Exceptions to the rule

Other Options

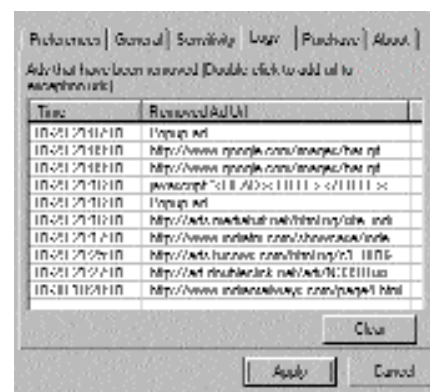
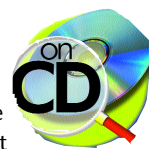
AdSubtract: This ad removal utility also blocks cookies and removes those that are already installed. It can also clean up your temporary Internet files and the browser's history log. Browsing speed might be hampered as AdSubtract prefetches sites to remove ads.

www.adsubtract.com

Ad Free: This software filters the content you browse and blocks sites that provide banners. It can also block any server you don't want to access.

Pop-Up Stopper Pro: This software lets you block certain ads while allowing certain others and plays sounds while ads are being blocked. It supports Windows XP and has a special feature that lets you locate your last downloaded file.

www.panicware.com



Check the ads trapped by AD Killer

You might want some popup windows to load when you visit certain sites. You can key in these sites in the 'Exception URLs list' under the 'Sensitivity' tab and AD Killer will ignore the popups when you visit those sites.

Keeping tabs

If you want to check what ads were blocked and which sites they originated from, click on the 'Logs' tab in the AD Killer window. You'll find a chronological list of all the ads that were blocked. If you find a site that has popup windows that